



▲ DEEP IN THOUGHT

Seen here in his laboratory, Tesla was clearly a man of science. However, he also claimed that he could speak eight languages.

LIFE STORY

1856

Nikola Tesla is born in the village of Smiljan, in what is now the country of Croatia. He claimed a lightning storm was raging as he was born.

1882

While living in Paris, France, Tesla works for the Continental Edison Company, set up by famed American inventor Thomas Edison.

1884

Tesla immigrates to the US, arriving with just four cents in his pocket, some of his favorite poems, and calculations for a flying machine.

1887

He develops the AC induction motor as an alternative to DC. It would soon become the most widely used type of electric motor.